PIONEERS

From B1

guard Isaac Johnson. "When he gets mad, we pick it up."

Led by Johnson and Brian Todd the Pioneers dominated the second half, especially the rebounding. The teams were even on the boards in the first half, but Elyria won the rebound battle 46-29.

"In the second quarter we let things other than basketball get to us," said Walsh. "That's the first time all year we've come unglued. Hopefully, we've learned not to let things like that bother us."

Ironically, it was a technical foul on the Rangers that helped Elyria regain command.

It was a 46-43 game midway through the quarter. Then Todd scored on a rebound and a technical was called on one of the Ranger players. Adam Larrick canned both free throws, then Jeff Sittinger fired in a 3-pointer to push the lead to 10.

The Rangers cut the lead to eight early in the fourth quarter and it was just 70-58 with less than half the quarter gone. Elyria finished the game with a 19-1 run, as the Rangers fired up seven threes in the final 3:45, making none. They were eight of 24 from the three-point line for the game.

Todd and Johnson, a pair of juniors, were outstanding for Elyria. Todd scored a career-high 22 points, grabbed 13 — nine on the offensive board — and had four steals.

Johnson had 13 points, nine assists and five steals. The Pioneers, as a team, passed the ball well in the second half.

'Brian is one of those kids who has a knack for being around the ball," said Walsh. "He's a good jumper, but he's only 6-foot-2. He leads us in rebounding and he give us a spark.

"Isaac played a great floor game. Nine assists is a great game. Even the passes that weren't assists helped us break their press."

Elyria's offensive rebounding was the thing that worried North Ridgeville coach Dan Radamaker most.

"Dave Baker got into foul trouble and he's not used to that," Radamaker said. "Most of the rebounds came in his area because he was playing a little too soft. He's got to learn to play in foul trouble."

Elyria shot 50.8 percent for the game, North Ridgeville just 33 percent, but only 29 in the second half.

In the junior varsity game Elyria, leading by seven at the half, went on a 12-0 run to start the third quarter and defeated North Ridgeville 55-40. The Pioneers, 8-0 against Erie Shore opponents, are 9-5 overall. The Rangers are 4-10.

Jamie Collins had 18, Will Oliver 13 and Brian Hopkins 11 for coach Wally Amburn's team.

ELYRIA
(89)

Players	GA	G	FA	FT	F	P
[illegible]e Brown	6	2	4	1	0	5
Brian Todd	9	8	6	6	2	22
Chris Readinger	7	3	[illegible]	0	4	6
Isaac Johnson	5	3	9	7	4	3
Adam Larrick	16	[illegible]	10	9	0	15
Mark Gatewood	1	0	5	0	3	0
Gus [illegible]	2	2	0	0	3	[illegible]
Jeff Sittinger		2	0	0	1	6
[illegible] Martin	5	4	[illegible]	0	1	8
Ricky Tusch	1			0	1	2
Nick Glowacki	2	2	0	0	[illegible]	[illegible]
TOTALS	51	31	33	23	19	89

N. RIDGEVILLE
(59)

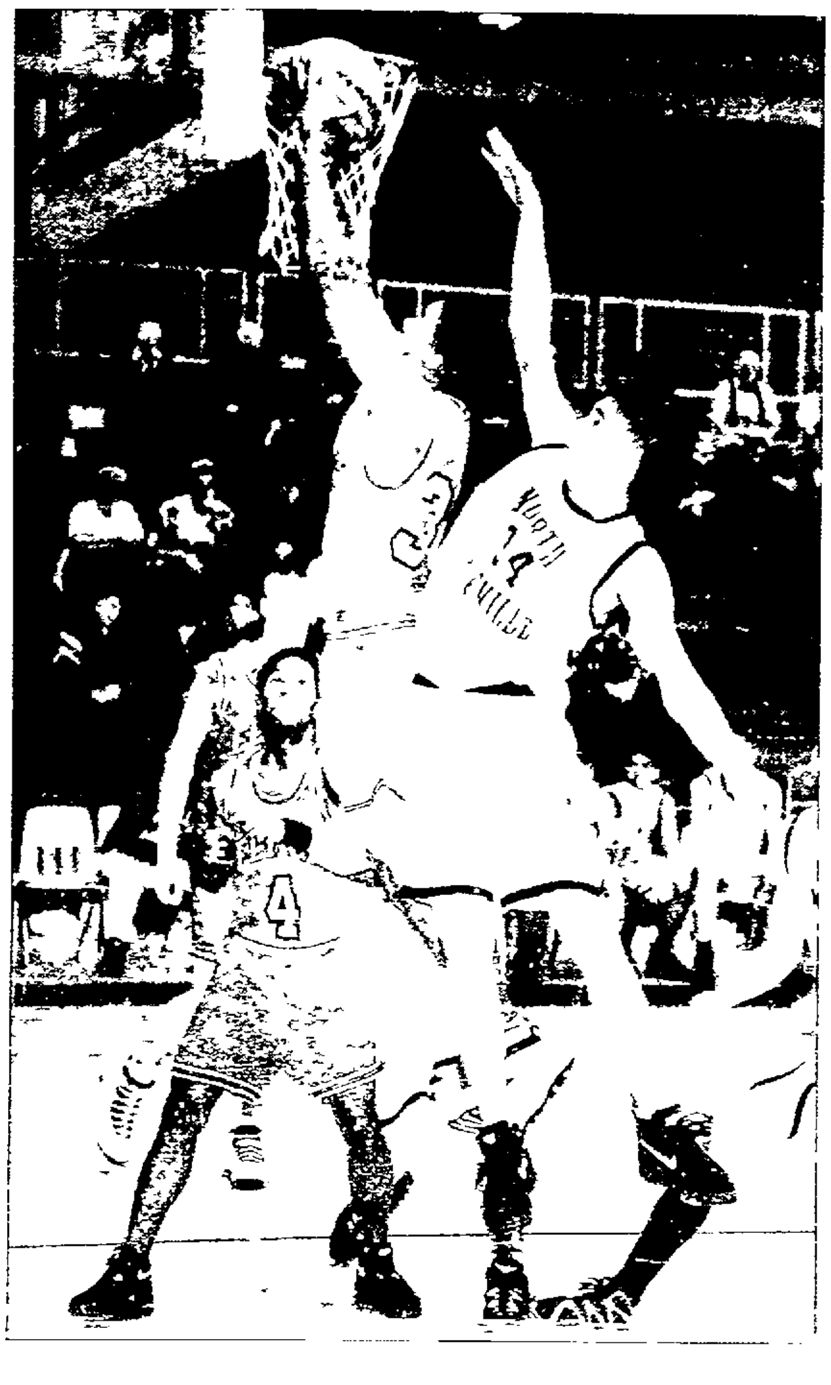
Players	GA	G	FA	FT	F	P
[illegible] Baker	2	3	2	1	3	9
Tom Whalen	1	4	2	0	2	8
Chad Sparrow	4	3	1	0	2	6
John Opfer	2	0	[illegible]	3	3	0
Josh Baker	3		0	0	1	4
Steve Elkins	11		[illegible]	3	3	17
Dan McNamara	3	2	6	6	3	14
C. Krukowski			1	0	2	2
Chris Belcher	0	0	0	0	0	0
Jesse [illegible]	5	[illegible]	2			1
[illegible] Castro	[illegible]	0	[illegible]	0		0
TOTALS	50	20	22	[illegible]	24	59

Three-point field goals: Elyria 4-15) Gatewood 0-1 Johnson 0-1 Larrick 2-7 Sittinger 2-6. North Ridgeville 8-24) D. Baker 2-7 Elkins 4-8 McNamara 2-[illegible] J. Baker 0-2

SCORE BY QUARTERS

	1	2	3	4		T
Elyria	18	17	24	30	—	89
N. Ridgeville	14	21	14	10	—	59

Junior Varsity: Elyria 55-40


TOM DANGERFIELD / CHRONICLE

CLEANING UP: Elyria's Brian Todd puts back an offensive rebound for a basket against North Ridgeville's Steve Elkins Friday night.

Fast start keys Westlake victory

Steve Byrne
The Chronicle-Telegram

WESTLAKE — So in what area will Westlake get better next?

"We always want to make improvements both in games and in daily practices," coach Art Daniels said. "One of the areas where we had a deficiency was that we weren't getting fast starts. Now, we've gotten fast starts in our last two games."

No problem on Friday night. The Demons hit Avon Lake early and often, and built an 18-point advantage by halftime before easing into a 63-51 victory in Southwestern Conference play.

Westlake is 10-1 in all games and unbeaten through six outings in the SWC. It was the second fast start in as many games the Demons enjoyed, as they distanced themselves from Olmsted Falls early in a 72-52 victory on Jan. 20.

"Against a well-coached team like Avon Lake you have to get a fast start or he (Coach Dick Deasy) will find a way to creep up on you," Daniels said. "We dominated them inside and that set the tempo."

Jason Hamann and Bret Fisher were the dominant ones. They combined to score all of Westlake's first 14 points and grab the Demons' first eight rebounds. No other Westlake players had a point or a rebound for the first 5:35 of the game.

Hamann scored eight points and six boards in that time. Zac Fiebig finally ended the Hamann-Fisher monopoly with a basket in the lane with 3:25 left in the first quarter.

"We got our butts kicked for the first time this year," Deasy said. "This was the first game we've played that we didn't have a chance to win it late."

The loss dropped the Shoremen to 7-6 overall and 3-4 in the SWC.

"They started like gangbusters and we never got our offense going," Deasy added. "They overwhelmed us early. I'm not disappointed with the effort, but it was just one of those nights."

The Demons jumped to leads of 10-1 and 18-3 in the first period. They scored the first eight points of the second quarter to go ahead by 18 and held a lead as big as 22 points with three minutes to go before intermission.

From there the Demons coasted. Their largest lead of the second half was 24 points. It was only a 14-2 run by the Shoremen to end the game that made the score as close as it was.

Fisher led all scorers with 21 points and Hamann was tops among rebounders with 10, eight of them in the opening quarter. Tom Koprowski was Avon Lake's only double figures scorer with 10.

Westlake faces Amherst in a conference game tonight. The Comets were upset by North Olmsted on Friday and will enter the game against the Demons with a 4-2 record in the SWC.

A.Lake	G	F	T	W'lake	G	F	T
Deasy	3	1	8	Compton	0	0	0
Morrissey		1	3	Hollick	3	0	7
Hurbanek	2	0	4	Myer	1	2	4
Koprowski	4	2	10	Fisher	8	5	21
Candea	1	2	4	Hamann	5	4	14
[illegible]	3	0	6	Fiebig	3	1	7
Fitz	1	0	3	Houser	0	1	1
Port	3	2	9	Blue	0	2	2
Nixon		0	2	Bixler	1	3	5
Jehn		0	2	Good	1	0	2
				Westfal	0	0	0
				Walker	0	0	0
				Capon	0	0	0
Totals	20	8	51	Totals	22	18	63

Score by Quarters

	1	2	3	4		T
Avon Lake	8	10	14	19	—	51
Westlake	18	18	19	8	—	63

Three-point goals: Hollick, Deasy, Port, Fitz
Junior Varsity: Avon Lake 48-42 OT

PANTHERS

From B1

straight win. Elyria Catholic (4-8, 2-5 NCL), meanwhile dropped its third in a row.

From the field, Chanel converted a sizzling 36-of-59 from the field while Elyria Catholic netted only 22-of-62 (35 percent).

While Panther head coach Mike Kearns was obviously frustrated, he wasn't at a total loss for words.

"Our league is very physical and we have not done a good job of adjusting," Kearns said. "We're not a very physical team and we need to be more physical.

"We're not going to grow anybody or put any weight on anybody, but hopefully, you can get kids geared with the idea of coming to meet passes, grabbing the ball with both hands and protecting the ball more, being strong with the ball and using their body and hips more for positioning and those kinds of things. A lot of its just an attitude, a mental approach."

After taking a 20-17 lead after the first eight minutes Friday night, little went the Panthers' way. The fact EC led was somewhat amazing as Chanel made eight of its first 11 shots. The Panthers sank nine of 18, including a 3-pointer by Jason Hart to beat the first period buzzer.

The second quarter spelled EC's demise as Chanel outscored the Panthers 24-8 to grab a commanding 41-28 advantage at the intermission. The Firebirds again were red hot from the field, sinking 11-of 16 (68 percent) while the Panthers were just four-of 11.

EC's woes were compounded when senior point guard Matt Nelson was benched by Kearns after receiving a technical foul with 3:56 left in the first half with Chanel leading 30-24.

Elyria Catholic never got closer than 11 points in the second half as Firebird head coach Greg Kraley got his first win over EC. He had two losses to the Panthers in his five year stint as head coach at Firelands (1986-91).

"We were fortunate tonight because we had been very sick this week," said Kraley. "We picked up a flu bug when we were in Columbus last weekend, and everybody got it. We had seven guys who missed at least two days of practice."

Senior Dave Hatch led EC with 15 points while classmate Mike Niederst added 10. Senior Mike Monastero and teammate Marcel Bouyer led the Firebirds with 14 points each while Marques Evans added 12. Jerome Cargile scored 11.

"We knew they wanted to shoot the three so we didn't want them to get any good looks at the basket," Kraley said. "The first half I don't think we did a very good job of that. The second half I think we did."

In the junior varsity game, Ryan Mack's 21-point effort propelled EC (8-3 overall, 6-1 NCL) to a 57-38 win over Chanel (3-10, 2-6 NCL). Matt Behne chipped in with 12 points.

Elyria Catholic will attempt to rebound Tuesday night when Cleveland Central Catholic invades the Coliseum.

ELYRIA CATHOLIC
(54)

Players	GA	G	FA	FT	F	P
Matt Nelson	8	3	0	0	1	6
Mike Niederst	5		0	0	1	10
Mark Blaser	3		0	0	0	[illegible]
Dave Hatch	18	6	4	2	0	15
Rob Peters	5	3	0	0	1	6
Jason Hart	5	2	0	0	1	5
Kevin Fritz	1	0	4	3	1	0
Dan Merrell		0	0	0	1	0
Poopen Patel	4	2	0	0	0	4
Ben Koch		0	2	2	2	2
Brian Dalton	0	0	0	0	0	0
Vince Kuebler	1	0	0	0	0	0
TOTALS	63	22	10	7	12	54

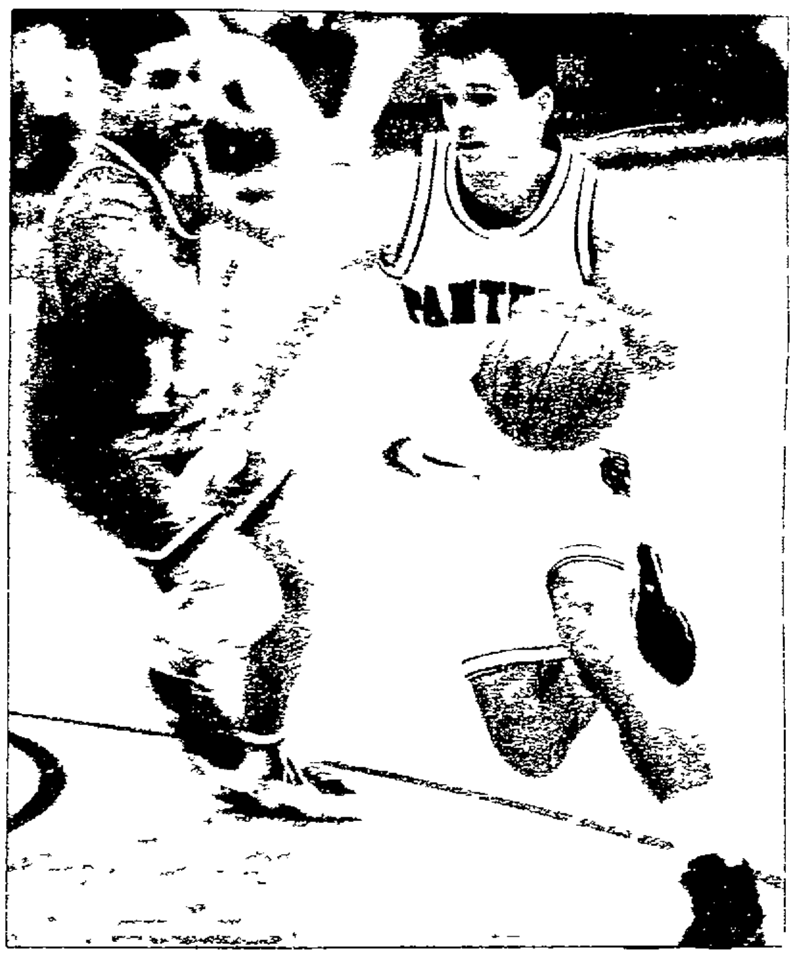
CHANEL
(77)

Players	GA	G	FA	FT	F	P
Izzy Santiago	10		2	1	2	9
Jerome Cargile	7	5	1	1	3	11
Mike Monastero	0	5	2		2	14
Mike Kalman	3	3	1	0	1	6
Marques Evans	9	6	0	0	0	12
Damon Fann	7	4	0	0	2	8
Marcel Bouyer	0	7		0	3	14
Salih Cinder	2	1	0	0	1	2
Wil Hameed	1	0	0	0	0	0
Kyle Pifer	0	0	2	1	0	0
TOTALS	59	35	12	4	14	77

Score by Quarters

Chanel	17	24	14	22	77
Elyria Catholic	20	8	16	10—	54

Three-point field goals: EC (3-14) Hart (2-5) Hatch 1-3 Price (0-1) Nelson (0-2) Niederst 0-3). Chanel (1-3) Monastero (1-2) Santiago 0-1
Junior varsity: Elyria Catholic 57-38


TERRY MAHL/CHRONICLE

MOVING ON: Elyria Catholic's Matt Nelson (4) drives past Chanel's Izzy Santiago.

North Olmsted stops Comets

NORTH OLMSTED — North Olmsted's Joe Smith made all six of his free throws during an overtime session as the Eagles bested Amherst 46-42 Friday night in a Southwestern Conference thriller.

Smith wound up with 12 points with teammate Keith Bielozer adding 11.

Rob Draga paced the Comets (4-2 SWC) with a game-high 13 points. Arturo Morante contributed 12 for the guests.

League action continues for the two teams tonight as both teams have home games. Amherst (7-5 overall) hosting Westlake and North Olmsted (also 7-5 overall, 3-3 SWC) greeting Bay in league play tonight — Olmsted Falls (8-3 overall) hosting Fairview and Bay (6-5 overall) traveling to North Olmsted.

Amherst	G	F	T	N. Olmsted	G	F	T
White	0	3	3	Kasler	1	2	5
Drusewcz	1	0	2	Bielozer	[illegible]	2	11
May	2	0	4	Maffett	2	0	[illegible]
Cline	2	0	5	Smith	3	5	12
Draga	4	4	13	Sulzer	2	0	4
Nixon	1	0	3	Godwin	1	0	2
Morante	4	4	12	Paton	[illegible]	0	8
Totals	14	11	42	Totals	17	10	46

Points by Quarters

	1	2	3	4	OT	T
Amherst	13	6	1	9	6	42
N. Olmsted	7	8	2	9	10	46

Three point goals: Amherst Cline Draga Nixon. North Olmsted Kasler Bielozer
Junior Varsity: Amherst 47-39

Olmsted Falls..................79
Bay..................56

BAY VILLAGE — Tim Schaefer's game-high 22 points led Olmsted Falls (3-3 SWC) to a 79-56 victory over Bay in Southwestern Conference action Friday night.

Matt Tabar (15) and Nick Neumeister (10) joined Schaefer in double figures for the Bulldogs.

Frank Garrity and Mike Masterson combined for 30 of the Rockets (2-4 SWC) points.

Both teams are right back in

Olm. Falls	G	F	T	Bay	G	F	T
DeLeao	3	0	6	Mussulin	1	2	4
Matus	2	2	6	Garrity	9	0	20
Tabar	4	[illegible]	15	Masterson	5	0	10
Munn		0	3	Scott	2	0	6
Moore	4	0	8	Barth	1	0	2
Johnson	2	0	5	Miller	3	0	7
Sippnbcky	2	0	4	Rodgers	3	0	7
Neumeister	4	2	10				
Schaefer	1	0	22				
Totals	33	8	79	Totals	24	2	56

Points by Quarters

	1	2	3	4		T
Olm Falls	18	16	21	24	—	79
Bay	21	12	17	5	—	56

Three-point goals: Olmsted Falls Tabar 3 Munn Johnson. Bay Garrity 2 Scott 2 Miller Rodgers.
Junior Varsity: Bay won.

Fairview..................63
Rocky River..................58

FAIRVIEW PARK — Fairview's (2-4 SWC) Paul Kerrigan poured in a game-high 25 points to lead the Warriors to a 63-58 Southwestern Conference triumph over Rocky River Friday night.

Chad Standring led three Pirates (2-5 SWC) in double figures with 19 points, including six three-pointers.

Fairview, 8-4 overall, journeys to Olmsted Falls tonight for another league game. Rocky River (6-7 overall) treks to Bay for a SWC game next Friday night.

RckyRvr	G	F	T	Fairview	G	F	T
Oakey	1		4	Boyer	4	1	9
Standring	[illegible]	1	19	Malesic	4	2	12
Strang		0	2	Cook	1	3	5
Kennedy		1	3	Kerrigan	9	6	25
Crane	[illegible]	2	11	Smith	3	4	10
Lietwo	[illegible]		[illegible]	Northofer	0	2	2
Kelic	5	0	10				
Totals	22	6	58	Totals	21	18	63

Points by Quarters

	1	2	3	4		T
Rocky River	6	15	[illegible]	12	—	58
Fairview	15	15	13	20	—	63

Three-point goals: Rocky River Oakey Standring 6 Crane. Fairview Malesic 2 Kerrigan
Junior Varsity: Rocky River won.

Columbia duo sinks Beachwood

BEACHWOOD — Barry Morton and Chris Putzier combined for 37 points to pace Columbia (4-4 MAC-8) to its 57-37 victory over Beachwood in MAC-8 action Friday night.

The Raiders, 5-7 overall, host Wellington tonight in non-conference action.

COLUMBIA (57): Ready 7 Morton 19 Burger 2 Schermann 1 Putzier 18 Sieu 2 Wolfe 2 Klen [illegible]
BEACHWOOD (37): Himmel 0 Fischer 9 Sabo 8 Washington [illegible] Carpenter 5

Points by Quarters

	1	2	3	4	T
Columbia	12	13	15	17	57
Beachwood	9	6	9	13	37

Junior Varsity: Columbia 47-25

Willo-Hill..................52
First Baptist..................51

ELYRIA — Willo-Hill outscored First Baptist by an 11-5 count in the fourth quarter to come away with a 52-51 win Friday night in Western Reserve Conference play.

Sean Carroll led the Sabres with 13 points, with Dave Fiest and Richard Woodward adding 10 apiece.

WILLO-HILL (52): Jones 15 Palumbo 0 Samaan 19 Denholm 6 Vrmick 2
FIRST BAPTIST (51): Stedman 8 Fiest 10 Cawley 6 Moore 4 Woodward 10 Carroll 13

Points by Quarters

	1	2	3	4		T
Willo-Hill	14	18	9	11	—	52
1stBap	23	9	14	5	—	51

Junior Varsity: First Baptist, 31-28

Open Door..................72
Mansfield C.S..................62

MANSFIELD — Kevin Delestathis' game-high 22 points, including three 3-pointers, paced Open Door (6-7) to its 72-62 victory over Mansfield Christian School in non-conference action Friday night.

OpenDoor	G	F	T	MnsfldCS	G	F	T
Matthews	6	3	6	Hooper	6	2	7
Cooksey	5	0	10	Rohrer		2	[illegible]
Delsths	9	1	22	Blunk	0	1	1
Faucher	[illegible]	2	9	Temperman	4	0	9
Koch	5		1	Fitzgerald	3	4	10
Watts		2	4	Lehew	6	0	12
				Happ	2	5	[illegible]
Totals	29	9	72	Totals	22	14	62

Points by Quarters

	1	2	3	4		T
Open Door	19	18	18	17	—	72
MnsfldCS	12	22	17	11	—	62

Three point goals: Open Door Matthews Delestathis 3 Faucher. Mansfield C.S. Hooper 3 Temperman

Strongsville..................64
Midpark..................47

MIDDLEBURG HEIGHTS — Jermaine Sheffield and Ryan Kilbane combined for 33 points to pace Strongsville to a 64-47 win over Midpark in Pioneer Conference action Friday night.

Strngsvlle	G	F	T	Midpark	G	F	T
Krabec	2	0	4	Piszczek	1	4	6
King	2	0	4	Rans	3	[illegible]	0
Benson	[illegible]	[illegible]	5	Argana	1	1	3
Kilbane	[illegible]	1	15	Turchek	0		
Stephens	2	0	4	Ciccerchi	[illegible]	1	7
Daher	1	0	3	Psomopanos	7	6	20
Chudy	1	0	3				
Sheffield	7	3	18				
Hodgson		0	2				
Cinnamon	3	0	6				
Totals	27	7	64	Totals	15	17	47

Points by Quarters

	1	2	3	4		T
Strongsville	8	9	17	20	—	64
Midpark	4	13	9	11	—	47

Three-point goals: Strongsville Daher Chudy Sheffield.

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